# CHAPTER 5

# SERVICE WRITING

## PRINCIPLES

"Nothing is more difficult, and therefore more precious, than to be able to decide".

Napoleon Bonaparte, French Emperor

### Purpose of Service Writing

1. In the Defence Services, the Service Writing is of utmost importance since at a glance it orients the reader what the originator wants to convey due to the adherence to the laid down conventions. It also highlights the significance of standardisation in the Armed Forces. Otherwise each person adopting a different format for the same subject leads to lot of confusion and as a result delays in the timely decision which is required to provide solutions. Unlike any other organisations, in the Armed Forces, discipline is the cornerstone of the sustenance of its command and control structure.

2. The term 'service writing' covers all writing originated by or on behalf of the Defence Services in an official capacity. It is divided into operational and non-operational writing.

a. **Operational Writing**. Operational writing encompasses: -

(1) Operation directives.

(2) Operation orders.

(3) Operation instructions.

(4) Administrative orders and instructions.

(5) Appreciations.

(6) Memoranda.

(7) Signal messages.

(9) Exercise orders.

(10) Tour notes.

(11) All forms of operational reports.

b. **Non –Operational Writing**. Non- operational writing covers all other forms of service writing.

## Characteristics of Service Writing

3. **Essential Elements**. Service writing should follow the normal rules of English writing style, paying particular attention to the following essential elements: -

a. **Accuracy**. The need for accuracy in facts and figures is obvious, but in writing there is a tendency to forget that exaggeration, over emphasis and indirect statements are inaccuracies.

b. **Brevity**. Brevity means the ability to inform the reader in the shortest possible time, without sacrificing simplicity, completeness or style. It does not mean shortness or telegraphy.

c. **Clarity**. Not only must the individual word or phrase have a clear and definite meaning, but also the sense of the whole should be easy to understand at the first reading. There should be no doubt as to 'what', 'who', 'where', 'when', or 'how much' is meant.

d. **Relevance**. Relevance includes both the exclusion of any irrelevant word, phrase or idea and the inclusion of all pertinent essentials. The test is, 'if this is cut out, will it prejudice the argument?

e. **Logic**. Not only must ideas not contradict each other but also the sentences and paragraphs should be linked together and follow logically. There must be continuity in the argument that is being projected.

4. **Style**. In order to convey to a reader the value of an idea or to justify a course of action, arguments in service writing must be based on facts presented in a logical order; the aim being to tell the tale plainly and simply. Good style therefore excludes the use of rhetorical phrases and demands a simple and straightforward arrangement; short words, short sentences and short paragraphs should be used wherever possible. It is ideal to limit the maximum number of words in a sentence to fifteen or twenty words. The reader will be distracted with lengthy sentences. On the other hand to avoid being dull and lifeless, style should be sufficiently attractive to hold the reader's attention.

a. **Words**. Exact knowledge of the meaning of every word used avoids uncertainty, vagueness or misunderstanding. Short words are preferable to long ones but what matters is the use of right word in the right context. For example use of word page has two different meanings; it may depict the page of a book or messenger or an aide to bride, whereas the correct word must be utilized to frame a meaningful sentence.

b. **Sentences and Paragraphs**. A forceful argument can be developed only by a logical sequence of sentences and paragraphs. Paragraphs may be sub divided for the purpose of clarity but

the unity of ideas expressed in each paragraph must be preserved. Short to the point sentences are called for, without being so brief that the whole paper loses its continuity.

c. **Punctuation**. Punctuation is simplified by the use of short sentences. For example; '**The collapse of Soviet Union led to creation of many independent countries like Latvia and Estonia which have embraced the democratic mainstream, thereby advocating liberalized economic policies**.' In this sentence the **comma (,)** and **which** have simplified the sentence. The **Semicolon** represents a pause of greater importance than that shown by the comma. To separate the clauses of compound sentence, when they contain a comma; as for e.g. He was a brave, large-hearted man; and we all honoured him. The colon marks a still more complete pause than that expressed by the Semicolon. It is used sometimes with a dash after it.

d. **Slang**. Slang and vernacular should be avoided; on the other hand the occasional use of an expressive word in the right place may add emphasis. For example **groundswell** is ideal means that the **environment** is favourable. The word has added colour to the sentence.

e. **Jargon and 'Officialese'**. Jargon is easily recognized but difficult to define. This may be misunderstood by those not familiar with the particular expression. 'Officialese' is neither concise nor clear and should be avoided. The following rules help to improve style: -

(1) Avoid abstract nouns where verbs or adjectives can be used.

(2) Use in active rather than the passive form of phrases.

(3) Be careful about introductory prepositional phrases.

(4) Use English words rather than words from other languages as far as possible.

(5) Use short rather than long words.

(6) Beware of cliché; they may be defensible for the purpose for which they were originally devised, but are often misapplied.

f. **Use of Latin / French Words**. In some instances Latin words with legal connotations are used but it is not advisable to use as it loses simplicity and the reader becomes puzzled. For example, following Latin words are used but it is better to use corresponding English meaning. However, depending upon the recipient's awareness of such words, if it is felt that such words express a precise message than English words then resorting to Latin words is a viable option.

(1) *Bona fide* - genuine

(2) *Mala fide* - bad faith

(3) *Modus operandi* - particular method of working or dealing with a task

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| (4) | *Fait accompli* | - | that cannot be changed again |
| (5) | *De facto* | - | existing or in actual fact, whether or not it is justified |
| (6) | *De jure* | - | by right or according to law |
| (7) | *Prima facie* | - | as per the appearance |
| (8) | *Inter alia* | - | Among other things |
| (9) | *Volte - face* | - | complete change of attitudes, policy or opinion. |
| (10) | *Prima donna* | - | a person who thinks he or she is very important |
| (11) | *Faux pas* | - | an action, remark, etc which causes embarrassment because it is not socially correct |
| (12) | *Quid pro quo* | - | a thing given in return for something else |
| (13) | *Hors d combat* | - | unable to take part in an activity or a sport because one is injured |
| (14) | *Vis-à-vis* | - | in relation to |

## Arrangement of Service Writing

5. **Framework**. Nearly every form of service writing has a framework, which consists essentially of three parts.

a. **Introduction**. The introduction provides the 'setting'. It may include the purpose of the letter, the background and any assumptions made. It should be brief and to the point, so that the reader is left in no doubt as to what the whole subject is about.

b. **Main Body**. The main body develops the argument in a logical order.

c. **Conclusion**. The paper must be properly rounded off, so that the reader is left with a clear and firm idea of the final result. The conclusion normally sums up the essential points, which have been argued out and may end with proposals or recommendations. New matter, not dealt with in the main body, should not be introduced.

6. **Layout**. Within the framework described above, a letter should be arranged under appropriate paragraphs. These help to break up the letter and provide the reader with mental pauses. Furthermore, the heading or the topic of the letter should elaborate the theme of the letter in a logical order.

7. In service writing, standard layouts are used to aid clear presentation of facts and discussions. A number of other rules or conventions are used to avoid ambiguity and misunderstanding.

8. These conventions make it easier for all those who handle service paper work, as described below: -

a. **The Writer**. Knowing the rules, the writer automatically conforms to the standard layout and does not have to invent his own.

b. **The Typist**. The typist does not have to adapt drafts to make them suitable to type. Nowadays process has become simplified due to usage of personal computers.

c. **The Reader**. The reader receives a document, which conforms to a familiar pattern and is unambiguous, thus making it easy to read and understand.

## Conventions of Layout

9. These rules apply to handwritten, computer printed and typed documents.

10. The conventions of layout explained in the succeeding paragraphs apply generally to all forms of service writing and in particular to a service paper. Certain additional conventions are used in other forms of service writing like correspondence, staff papers, orders and instructions. These additional conventions are explained later in this handbook.

11. Most service documents are laid out in a similar manner. They consist of three parts, namely the superscription, the text and the subscription. The superscription contains everything above the text and the subscription everything below it. The contents of each part will vary with the type of document. A general example is given in the succeeding page.

**CONFIDENTIAL**

SLNS Tissa
Naval Base
Trincomalee
Tel… Ext…

T/ 01

The Commander Eastern Naval Area

20 Aug 05

Superscription

**ATTACHMENT OF ADDITIONAL TROOPS FOR CONVOY ESCORT DUTIES**

Reference: The Commander Eastern Naval Area letter no CE/02 dated 05 Aug 05.

1. In light of the deteriorating security situation in area, the vested burden on SLNS Tissa to escort routine convoy, in addition to other security chores has become double fold. The current deployment pattern of personnel in various security related assignments is placed herewith as an **Annexure**.

2. Hence considering aforesaid facts, it is requested to attach adequate number of personnel from other establishments in area to overcome the prevailing impasse.

Text (from main heading to last line of final paragraph )

H S PERERA
Captain (N)
Commanding Officer

Subscription

**Annexure**: Deployment Pattern

**CONFIDENTIAL**

12. The superscription in all service documents will have the following in the order given below: -

a. **Right Hand Top Corner**.

(1) Precedence (if any).

(2) Copy number (if any).

(3) Own address.

(4) Telephone number with extension number if available (Telephone number is not mandatory and may be inserted as per the circumstances).

(5) Date.

b. **Left Hand Top Corner**.

(1) Attention for designated authority (if any).

(2) File reference.

(3) Addressees.

(4) Salutation (as per the circumstances).

**Use of Syllables**

13. The typing should finish a minimum of five spaces before reaching the right hand edge. To achieve this, long words may be divided. Place and personal names will, however, not be split. Word splitting should be done with care and according to the following methods: -

a. **Prefixes**. A word may be split after a prefix, e.g., pre-war, post-war, ante-date.

b. **Suffixes**. A word may be split before a suffix, e.g. useful-ness, careless-ness.

c. **Syllables**. Where it is not possible to split a word after a prefix, or before a suffix it will be split between syllables. A syllable itself will not be split; e.g. indis-putable, and not ind-isputable.

14. It is preferable to type the greater part of the word on the first line. For example, conver-sation is better than con-versation. A word should not be split before a vowel unless the vowel is part of a recognized suffix.

15. A page should not end with a divided word.

## Date

16. A date is written in the order of day **(two** digits), month and year. A month is abbreviated by using the first three letters of the month followed by the last two figures of the year as follows: -

a. In full - 05th October 2002

b. Abbreviated - 05 Oct 02

17. When referring the year other than the current century, the year should be written in full e.g., 25th October 1965 is written as 25 Oct 1965. A date will always be abbreviated when writing within the Armed Forces. It will be written in full when writing to civilians, in formal letters and when legal requirements demand it. In typescript the day left blank by the typist and is completed by the signatory. Dates are not be underlined.

## Spacing

18. The rules regarding vertical and horizontal spacing of typescript are given in Annex 'A' and 'B' of chapter 6.

## Numerals

19. Arabic numerals are used in all service writing, which includes sections, chapters, enclosures, paragraphs and pages etc. This is to avoid mistakes such as confusion of the Roman numeral II with the Arabic numeral 11. Numbers one to nine are normally written in words except when they are used in the dimensional sense. E.g., 6 inch shell, or when they are part of the title of a formation or unit. If adjacent numbers indicate quantities and dimensions, the first should either be spelled out, e.g., twelve 10-ton trucks, or the adjacent numbers separated by the multiplication sign. E.g., 12 x 10-ton trucks. If numbers below and above nine are contained in the same sentence, they should all be written in words or in figures whichever seems more appropriate.

## Use of Capital Letters

20. **Block Capital**. Capital letters are used for every letter of: -

a. Titles of documents.

b. Centre headings.

c. Reference letters of annexes and appendices, e.g. Annex A.

d. Code words, nicknames, link signs, code signs, abbreviated names of regiments/ corps (as authorized) and Naval lettered positions.

e. Precedence including when used in the text.

f. Security classifications including when used in the text.

g. Abbreviation used to denote intermediate points of the compass, e.g. NE, SSW.

h. Abbreviation composed of initial letters of words or acronyms, e.g. CDS, JOH and SACEUR (Supreme Allied Commander in Europe-the senior most officer commanding NATO forces in Europe, usually an American four star general)

j. Following words, orders and instructions: -

(1) LEFT and RIGHT when indicating directions.

(2) NO and NOT.

21. **Initial Capitals**. Apart from the opening word of a sentence, capital letters used for the letter of: -

a. The important words in all headings other than titles and centre headings, and in titles of references and attachments when listed.

b. The opening words of paragraphs and sub paragraphs and sub-sub paragraphs.

c. Important words in titles of charts, sections, documents, manuals, regulations and publications when these are listed or quoted.

d. Proper nouns.

e. Abbreviations for all 'ranks' are to be written initial capital irrespective of the context, e.g., LCdr Jayathilake, two Lt Cols.

f. Address of the originator, e.g.,

Naval Headquarters
Po. Box. 593
Colombo 01

**Spelling**

22. The Oxford English Dictionary will be considered as the Standard English dictionary for spelling, where alternative spellings are given, the first will be used.

## Underlining

23. Words or phrases in the text are not to be underlined for emphasis. If emphasis is required, the sentence should be suitably framed.

## Quotation Marks

24. **Double Quotation Marks**. Double equation marks are used to enclose direct quotations, expressions, phrases, sentences or titles that are reproduced in the actual words of the originator, author, speaker or source.

25. **Single Quotation Marks**. The occasions when single quotation marks are used are given below: -

a. To enclose a quotation within a quotation, e.g. "Kumar Sangakkara is the 'best wicket keeper batsman' produced by Sri Lanka."

b. To enclose foreign or scientific words or phrases, that would, in print, normally be shown in italics, e.g. ´fait accompli ', 'double diversity,' 'inter-se,' 'fission-fusion-fission'.

c. To set apart or highlight certain words or phrases, e.g., the use of 'shall' and 'will' requires careful thought.

## Abbreviations

26. Abbreviations are a means of saving time. They are intended to be helping not a hindrance. Consistency is therefore a pre-requisite.

27. The use of abbreviations will be confined to those which are officially recognized and which will be known to all recipients of the document. Abbreviations used in this manual, e.g., 'Tel, 'Ext,' 'Para' and so on, together with those used on a map or chart referred to, may also be used. Additionally, they may be used if the meaning is clearly indicated when first used, e.g., 'Multiple Independently targeted Re-entry Vehicles' (MIRV). Full stops are not used in or after abbreviations, e.g., MIRV and not M.I.R.V.

28. Abbreviations may be used in all types of service writing except as follows: -

a. Correspondence with civil authorities (except universally used abbreviations like, e.g., i.e., lb, Rs and so on).

b. Correspondence dealing with legal matters that may debar the use of abbreviations.

29. In correspondence with the other Service, only officially promulgated inter-Service abbreviations are to be used.

## Date and Time

30. All services documents will have a date of origin. When given the date of origin or quoting a date in the text it should be abbreviated as explained in Para 10 and 11.

31. A night is described by both dates over which it extends, e.g. Night 29/ 30 Sep 04 and Night 30 Sep/ 01 Oct 04.

32. Time will always be expressed in four figures by reference to the 24 hour clock followed by the abbreviated word 'hrs'. In operational writing the four figures to be followed by the zone time suffix unless the zone of all times in the document is made clear by a general statement e.g., All Times: Zone Minus 3 (Charlie) or it is obviously not necessary.

33. Indefinite terms such as 'dusk', 'dawn', 'day light', should be avoided while describing precise time. The term 'midnight' is not used. When it is necessary to refer to that precise time '2400 hrs' is used. If possible, '2400 hrs' should also be avoided and '2359 hrs' or 0001 hrs should be used instead.

34. Date/ time groups (DTG) are used in signal messages only. They consist of six figures, first two giving the date and last four the time.

35. **Letters Used in Relation to an Operation**. Certain alphabets are used to indicate the hour on which a given operation is to be mounted. These are: -

a. **M Day**. The day on which mobilization is to begin is known as M Day.

b. **D Day**. The day on which hostilities, or an operation, begin or are to begin, is normally known as D Day.

c. **H Hour**. The specific hour on D Day at which hostilities or the main operation begins, is known as H Hour.

d. **N Hour**. The time planned for the explosion of a tactical nuclear weapon is known as N Hour.

e. **P Hour**. The time of drop of the first sticks on the main body in an airborne operation is known as P Hour.

36. **Numbering of Days and Hours**. Days relative to D Day are numbered. D minus 3 (i.e. D minus three days), D minus 2, D minus 1, as appropriate if earlier than D Day, and D plus 1, D plus 2, D plus 3, as appropriated if later. The same rule applies to all lettered days and hours (i.e. H minus 2 or H plus 40 minutes).

# CHAPTER 6

## NOTES ON STANDARD LAYOUT FOR SERVICE WRITING

### Security Classification

1. Security classification is graded or categorised into one of four classifications: -

a. **Top Secret**. Information or material, the unauthorised disclosure of which would cause exceptionally grave damage to the nation.

b. **Secret**. Information or material, the unauthorised disclosure of which would cause serious injury to the interest of the nation.

c. **Confidential**. Information or material, the unauthorised disclosure of which would prejudice the interest of the nation.

d. **Restricted**. Information or material, the unauthorised disclosure of which would be undesirable to the interest of the nation.

2. The originator of the documents assigns the appropriate classification. Care should be taken to avoid over classification. The classification is to be marked so that it can be seen at a glance on each page of typescript in capitals and rubber stamped, preferably in red. Annexed documents should be classified at least as high as the most highly classified section of the document. Covering letters, minutes and the docket should also be similarly classified. Security classifications must be in block capitals and underlined. E.g., **TOP SECRET**

### Privacy Marking

3. Documents that do not require security classification, but requiring a degree of protection and special handling are to be endorsed with a 'Privacy marking', e.g. 'IN CONFIDENCE' preceded by STAFF or MEDICAL if necessary. If it contains classified information it is to be given a security classification in addition.

4. Letters or documents intended exclusively for a particular person should be placed in an inner sealed envelope and clearly marked 'to be opened by……' (not to be confused, with 'For the attention of. ... ').

### Precedence

5. Letters and papers requiring quick handling may be given a precedence marking. There are two degrees of precedence.

a. **IMMEDIATE**. Reserved for matters of great urgency and takes priority in handling and action.

b. **PRIORITY**. Reserved for matters requiring precedence over ordinary business.

## Copy Numbering

6. All TOP SECRET and SECRET documents are to bear individual copy number e.g. 'Copy No. 1 of 20' and including annexes or trace, forming part of the document. Covering letter or minute is also to be copy numbered. When copies of such documents are taken it is to be marked 'REPRODUCTION Copy No…of…'

## Address of Sender

7. The address of sender is shown at top right hand corner. Different conventions are shown in various letters shown as examples.

## Identifying Reference

8. All Service writing has an identifying reference in the form of numbers or letters or a combination of both. Supplementary documents other than enclosures bear the reference of the parent document. The identifying reference is placed in line with the last line of originator's address.

## Telephone Number

9. Telephone number with extension number if any, is shown if considered necessary.

## Date

10. The date is shown in full in Command, Directed, Formal, Demi-Official and Business letters, but is abbreviated in all other types of service writing. Date is to be hand written or in manuscript. In respect of inserting date of annexes, here also date to be hand written.

## Addressee

11. The full address need not be typed where the office of the address is obvious i.e. Commander of the Navy, Commander Eastern Naval Area etc. There is no laid down rule as to how many addressees may be included in superscription before switching to 'See Distribution'. However, as a general guideline if there are more than four addressees then you may switch over to ‘See Distribution’. A useful rule to apply is that the subject heading should not be more than 1/2 way down the first page.

## Salutation

12. The salutation only appears in Formal, Demi-Official and Business letters. The choice of salutation in Demi-Official letters depends upon relative ranks and the degree of intimacy existing between the writer and the recipient. Assuming that LCdr AT Agalawatta is writing a Demi-Official letter to LCdr CD Somaratna, the salutations in order of formality are: -

a. Dear Lieutenant Commander Somaratna,

b. Dear Lieutenant Commander,

c. My dear/ Dear Somaratna,

13. The Salutation must be followed by a comma to indicate continuity. For example Sir, or Dear Somaratna,

14. It may be noted that ranks, if used in the salutation, are not to be abbreviated. Officers should normally be addressed by their generic rank wherever applicable. These are as follows: -

a. **Army**. All officers of the ranks of Major General to General are addressed as 'General'. Likewise officers of the rank of Lieutenant Colonel are addressed as 'Colonel'

b. **Navy**. All officers of the ranks of Rear Admiral to Admiral are addressed as 'Admiral'.

c. **Air Force**. All officers of the ranks of Air Vice Marshal to Air Marshal are addressed as 'Air Marshal'.

15. Bearing in mind the guiding principles laid down in paragraph 12, some examples are indicated as follows: -

a. 'My dear/ Dear General'.

b. 'My dear/ Dear Commodore'.

c. 'My dear/ Dear Group Captain'.

d. 'My dear/ Dear Colonel'.

e. 'My dear/ Dear Commander Wevita'.

## The Title

16. Every service document, except demi-official letters (in which the use of title is optional) must have

a title. It should be chosen with care and should be comprehensive enough to cover all aspects of the subject being dealt with. When a paper has been revised it is as well to recheck the title and to alter it, if necessary to conform to the revised text.

17. The title is written as a centre heading in block letters and underlined. It is aligned in the centre of the typed area of the first page and placed three spaces below any preceding line. If the length of the title requires more than one line, the second and subsequent lines are symmetrically typed and centred below the first line in single spacing. Two typical examples are shown as follows: -

**TEACHING OF TACTICS TO JUNIOR OFFICERS UP TO THE RANK OF LIEUTENANT COMMANDER**

**MINUTES OF MEETING HELD IN THE COMMAND CONFERENCE ROOM NORTHERN COMMAND AT 14OO HRS ON 12 JAN 05 TO DISCUSS TRAINING POLICY FOR 2005**

## Headings

18. Where a document is lengthy or subject complex the text is divided by headings. These assist the writer's logical development of thought and direct the reader's attention to what follows. Headings should stand on own and not form a part of any sentence that follows. All headings must be in bold and underlined.

19. **Subject Heading**. Most documents start with a short statement of the subject called the subject heading. Other types of headings are: -

a. **Main Heading**. Main headings are placed centrally over the typed area in underlined capitals and are not followed by a full stop. In a two line heading, if one line is necessarily shorter than the other, the second line is to be shorter and placed centrally under the first.

b. **Group Heading**. A group heading is used to introduce one or more paragraphs on the same general subject. It is a line by itself beginning at the left hand margin; it is not numbered and is not followed by a full stop. Initial capitals are used for important words and underlined.

c. **Paragraph Heading**. A paragraph heading covers only one paragraph and any integral sub-paragraphs. Initial capitals are used for important words; the heading is underlined and followed by a full stop. The full stop is not bold and not underlined. Not every paragraph need have a heading, but once used, succeeding paragraphs down to the next main group heading should have headings. A paragraph heading may be on a line by itself followed immediately by a

sub-paragraph. A paragraph heading is typed on the same line as the paragraph number and is placed between the number and the first word of the text.

d. **Sub-Paragraph Headings**. Sub paragraph headings and those of any further sub-divisions follow rules similar to those for paragraph headings. Like in paragraph headings the full stop is not bold and not underlined.

## Reference(s)

20. References made to any document not enclosed with the letter or paper should be given with title or identifying reference number. The originating authority is to be prefixed to reference number. Each document listed is to be identified by a capital letter and may be referred to in the text. When single reference only is involved, particularly in Demi-Official letters or those to civilians, it may be included in the text. When there are many references, the initial reference must be that of the oldest and sequentially followed by recent or the latest.

## Numbering of Paragraphs

21. Paragraphs are numbered in Arabic numerals. A single paragraph is not numbered. Also, alphabetical letters I and O is not used in numbering the paragraphs. A paragraph should preferably have more than single subparagraph. In letters to public, good taste should decide its necessity. Paragraphs in letters of condolence, for example, would never be numbered.

## Page Numbering

22. All pages of documents other than single page documents are to be numbered at the bottom centre three spaces above security classification or from the bottom centre of the typed area of the paper if no security classification is used. However, in a multiple page document the first page is not to be numbered except Secret and Top Secret documents. The second page in a multiple page document would start with serial number 2. Pages of an Annex including the single page annex are to be given letter of that particular Annex followed by page number e.g. A - 1, A – 2, B - 1 etc.

23. In Secret and Top Secret documents the first page is also to indicate the total number of pages of the document e.g. 1 of 1 or 1 of 20.

## Supplementary Documents

24. It is standard procedure to have following attachments: -

a. Annexure/ Annex (interchangeable) as the primary attachments to operation orders, and in general to papers.

b. Appendices as attachments to an Annex.

c. Enclosures to a letter.

25. **Annexes**. Document amplifying the parent document is an Annex. An annex is used to include details relating to matters in the parent document. An annex should: -

a. Be referred to in the text of the parent document.

b. Be lettered consecutively in capitals in the order in which they appear in the text.

c. Have own subject heading.

d. Be listed at the close of the parent document giving subject heading of annex.

e. Show the identifying reference of the main document. It may be shown as follows: -

**ANNEX A TO**
**COMEAST LETTER NO NTC/ 05**
**DATED 06 FEB 05**

f. If classified above confidential to be copy numbered.

g. Page numbering of Annex is denoted by the letter of that particular Annex followed by page number of the Annex followed by total number of pages in the parent document. For example **A-1 of 1** indicates that it is the first page of Annex A and a single page parent document, and **C-2 of 20** indicates that it is the second page of Annex C consisting of 20 pages in parent document.

26. **Appendices**. Supplementary documents that amplify an Annex are called appendices. They should be: -

a. Be referred to in the text of parent Annex.

b. Be numbered consecutively in Arabic numerals.

c. Have own subject heading.

d. Be listed at close of parent Annex (not main parent document).

e. Show identifying reference of the main document, e.g.,

**APPENDIX 1 TO ANNEX A TO**
**COMEAST LETTER NO NCT/05**
**DATED 06 FEB 05**

f. Be copy numbered if classified above confidential.

g. Page numbering of Appendix first indicates the particular letter of the relevant Annex followed by the serial number of Appendix followed by page number of the Appendix and then followed by total number pages in the parent document. For example, **A1-1 of 1** is Annex A Appendix 1 first page of Appendix 1 and single page parent document, and **C2-2 of 20** indicates that it is Annex C Appendix 2 and page 2 of Appendix 2 consisting of 20 pages in parent document.

27. **Enclosure**. Documents which are complete in themselves sent with parent document are called enclosure and are listed numerically at the end of parent document under heading 'Enclosures', e.g. in case of many enclosures as follows: -

**ENCLOSURE 1**
**TO COMEAST LETTER NO NCT/ 05**
**DATED 06 FEB 05**

28. Enclosures are independent in nature and may contain extractions from other documents. With regard to a single enclosure it will appear as follows: -

**ENCLOSURE**
**TO COMEAST LETTER NO NCT/ 05**
**DATED 06 FEB 05**

29. Attachments must be fastened to the parent paper and bear its reference number and date. The date must be same as the date in the parent document. An attachment may have a lower security grading than the parent paper but never a higher grading.

## Signature

30. In all service writing other than in demi-official letters, identity of signatory is shown in signature block, together with title of the authority. The signature block therefore contains: -

a. The initials and name of signatory in block capitals. Commodore above may use initials or their first name in the signature block.

b. Signatory's rank and service where appropriate.

c. The originating authority that may be either the signatory's appointment or that of the superior for whom he is signing, in which case the word 'for' will be typed or written in the signature block.

d. If circulation is within the Navy, after the rank SLN is not required to be included. Only in cases of correspondence with other Services and civilian organisations SLN is to be inserted.

31. The signatory should personally sign the copies of documents to addressees who are senior to the authority on whose behalf the document is signed. Other copies may be rubber-stamped.

32. Signature block for correspondence within a headquarters will be made out as for the appointment. For all service documents going outside headquarters, the signature will be either for the Commander or head of the branch in accordance with the following convention: -

a. For lower formations, the signature will be authorised on behalf of the Commander/ head of the branch, unless the document contains any admonitory or laudatory reference.

b. For higher and equal formations, the signature will be authorised on behalf of the Commander.

c. All correspondence containing admonitory or laudatory references will be personally signed by the Commander.

d. All correspondence concerning important policy matters will be signed by the head of the branch when addressed to lower formations and by the Commander when addressed to higher formations.

e. Service decorations should follow as per the sequence/ precedence after the surname.

f. When an officer is officiating as the Commander/ Director/ CO etc, then the word ‘Offg’ is placed before the designation in the signature block. An example of such a signature block is as follows: -

sd/-

AB ATTANAYAKE
Commander
Offg Commanding Officer

33. In the case of an officer acting in an appointment for his superior the signature block is as follows: -

sd/-

AB ATTANAYAKE
Commander
Actg Commanding Officer

34. It is customary in the Navy, when temporarily overseeing in an appointment, to sign on behalf of the superior officer and to thereafter indicate the reason for the absence of the latter in brackets below that appointment. The reasons for absence are to be limited to: -

a. AOL (Away on Leave).

b. AOD (Away on Duty).

c. AS (Absent Sick).

35. An example of a signature block in the eventuality mentioned at paragraph 34 above is as follows: -

sd/-

CL KELEGAMA
Lieutenant Commander (N)
for Commanding Officer (AOL)

36. Some examples of signature block are given below: -

sd/-

AB ATHAUDA
Captain (ASW)
Commanding Officer

sd/-

MPA JAYASUNDARA
Lieutenant Commander (G)
for Commanding Officer (AOD)

sd/-

GA JAYASOORIYA, RSP, USP, psc
Commodore
Offg Commander Eastern Naval Area

sd/-

DD NIRIALLA, RSP, USP
Commodore
Director Naval Training
for Commander of the Navy

sd/-

DINESH MAPITIGAMA RSP, USP, psc, MSc (DS)
Commodore
for Commander Northern Naval Area (AOL)

## Concluding Remarks

37. Concluding remarks appear in formal, Demi-official and Business letters. In Demi- official letters and formal letters it must appear as 'Yours faithfully'. In respect of felicitation messages, congratulatory messages and condolence messages 'Yours sincerely' can be used.

38. In respect of letters to civilians, depending upon the level of interaction, it should appear as follows: -

Thanking you

Yours sincerely / Yours truly / Yours affectionately

## Distribution

39. If there are many addressees to a document they are listed under a heading 'Distribution' immediately after the signature block. Action and information addressees are shown separately and term 'See Distribution' is inserted in the normal, addressee position. When there are several addressees the order in which they are to be listed is to be in order of seniority. If the addressee block exceeds four addressees, the practise is to switch to 'See Distribution'

## Expressing Orders and Instructions

37. **The Form of the Imperative**. Certain forms of imperatives used to convey orders and instructions are as follows: -

a. **'Is to'** or **'Are to'**. The words 'is to' or 'are to' used to convey direct orders.

b. **To (Infinitive)**. The infinitive form of the verb is used to express an aim, mission or intention.

c. **Should**. 'Should' is used in directives or instructions to express the requirement, leaving a measure of discretion to the local Commander.

d. **Will**. 'Will' is used only to convey information or to express the future tense.

38. **Specific Meanings**. The following words have specific meanings in the Navy: -

a. **Intend**. 'Intend' is used to signify an intention, which will be carried out unless countermanded by higher authority.

b. **Propose**. 'Propose' is used, particularly in signal messages, to suggest a proposed course of action, which will not be carried out unless approved by higher authority.

c. **Request**. When used by a senior to a junior, 'request' is a polite method of conveying an order. Otherwise, its meaning is according to the English usage.

d. **Will**. 'Will' is used only to convey information or express the future tense.

## Telephone Number

39. Telephone number with extension number if any, is shown if considered necessary.

## Notes

40. When it is necessary to use notes in amplification of the text or tabulated information the heading 'Notes' should be used at the end of the letter and each note numbered serially in Arabic numerals.

## Multiple Signatories

41. When a document is to be signed by more than one person of equal protocol, the signature blocks will be in the same horizontal line with the senior most signing on the extreme right.

## Decorations

42. Decorations may be included after the name of the signatory and as per the protocol of the medals and academic qualifications, as indicated in examples at Para 36 above and as per the existing Navy List.

## Date in Manuscript

43. The date of the letter or the document and the date in the Annex with the signature in the signature block must be in manuscript. The idea of writing the date in manuscript is that the signatory has seen the parent document and the supplementary documents on the day of signing.

## Standard Layout

44. An example of a standard layout is shown in **Annex A**.

**ANNEX A TO CHAPTER 6**

## THE STANDARD LAYOUT

3

**SECURITY CLASSIFICATION**
**PRIVACY MARKING** 1

PRECEDENCE 1
Copy No. of … 1
Address of Sender 1
Tel…

Identifying Reference **(in line with last line of Address)**

2

Addressee(s) or See Distribution

Date **(in line with last line of Addressee)**

3

Salutation

3 ( if salutation is not there the distance between addressee(s) and subject heading is 3 spaces).

**SUBJECT HEADING**

5

Reference(s): A. 3

B. 1

5

2

1. This example illustrates the basic conventions of the standard layout in skeleton form, using notes in the superscription and subscription and words in the text. Not all the examples given need necessarily apply in every type of document. 1

3

**HEADINGS** 3

2. The text may be divided by main, group and paragraph headings. The heading above this paragraph is a main heading. It is placed centrally, as is the subject heading, because the document contains both main and group headings.

3

**PRIVACY MARKING**
**SECURITY CLASSIFICATION** 1

3

3

**SECURITY CLASSIFICATION** 1
**PRIVACY MARKING**

3

**Further Sub Division**

2

3. Group headings introduce one or more paragraphs on the same subject; the heading immediately above this paragraph is an example. 1

2

4. **Paragraph Headings**. A paragraph heading covers only its own paragraph and any sub-paragraph in it. A subdivision of a paragraph may have a heading.

2

5. **Sub Paragraphs**. 2

a. This is an example of a sub-paragraph and further sub division is possible:

2

(1) By sub-sub paragraphs, of which this is an example, and by

2

(a) Sub-sub-sub paragraphs, of which there may be several. Still further sub-division could be achieved thus: -

2

(i) Sub-sub-sub-sub-paragraphs, of which this an example. Care must be taken not to overdo the subdivision of paragraphs and in non-operational writing it will not usually be necessary to subdivide further than sub-sub-paragraphs.

2

(ii) ...

2

(b) ...

2

6. The main paragraph may be continued, like this, after the sub-paragraphs have been completed.

3

PAGE NO

3

**PRIVACY MARKING**
**SECURITY CLASSIFICATION**

3

3

**SECURITY CLASSIFICATON** 1
**PRIVACY MARKING**

3

**SUPPLEMENTARY DOCUMENTS**

3

7. A variety of supplementary documents might accompany this particular document. An annex, which accompanied it, would be referred to in the text and would be listed below. An appendix to that annex would be referred to in the annex and similarly listed. An enclosure would be a complete document in itself and would be indicated at the close of the parent document

2

8. An example of the layout of an annex is at Annex A to this paper.

5

Appropriate ending and subscription 1

2

**Annexes**: A. Layout of an annex 1
B.

2

**Enclosures**: 1..... 1
2.....

2

**Distribution**: **Copy No**.

2

**External**:

2

**Internal**:

2

**Information**:

3

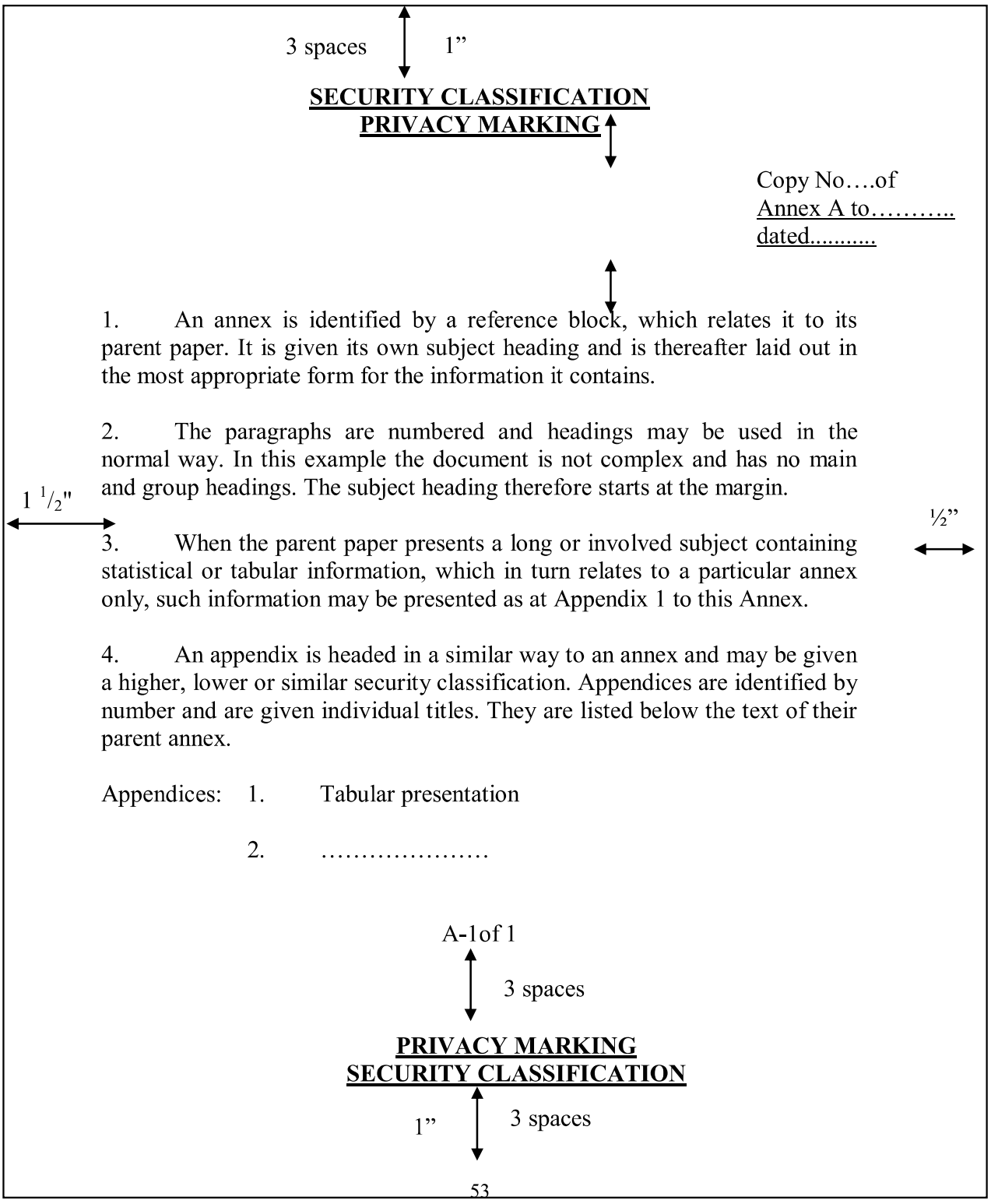
PAGE NO

3

**PRIVACY MARKING**
**SECURITY CLASSIFICATION** 1

3

# LAYOUT OF AN ANNEX




1. An annex is identified by a reference block, which relates it to its parent paper. It is given its own subject heading and is thereafter laid out in the most appropriate form for the information it contains.

2. The paragraphs are numbered and headings may be used in the normal way. In this example the document is not complex and has no main and group headings. The subject heading therefore starts at the margin.

3. When the parent paper presents a long or involved subject containing statistical or tabular information, which in turn relates to a particular annex only, such information may be presented as at Appendix 1 to this Annex.

4. An appendix is headed in a similar way to an annex and may be given a higher, lower or similar security classification. Appendices are identified by number and are given individual titles. They are listed below the text of their parent annex.

Appendices: 1. Tabular presentation

2. ……

1"

**SECURITY CLASSIFICATION**
**PRIVACY MARKING**

Copy No. …of …
Appendix 1 to
Annex A to……
dated……..

**Tabular Presentation**

Facts may be presented in tabular form. The following is an example.

| Serial No. | Column Title | Column Title | Column Title | Column Title |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| (a) | (b) | (c) | (d) | (e) |
| 1. | | | | |
| 2. | (Lines are normally drawn between columns and between serials) | | | |
| 3. | | | | |
| 4. | | | | |

1½" ←→ ½"

3
A1-1of 1
3

**PRIVACY MARKING**
**SECURITY CLASSIFICATION**

1" 3

54

# CHAPTER 7

# SERVICE CORRESPONDENCE

## Introduction

1. Service correspondence is a generic term for correspondence written by members of the Services in the course of their duties. It incorporates agreed rules for the preparation and layout of service paper work and standardises staff procedures. It is meant to cover all writing originated-officially from within the Service.

2. **Composition of Text**. In all but the shortest letters on routine matters, the text should consist of an introduction, a theme and a conclusion.

a. **Introduction**. The introduction gives the purpose of the letter with a short summary of any background information.

b. **Theme**. The theme presents the case, lists any arguments or problems in concise and logical sequence.

c. **Conclusion**. The conclusion summarizes the important points mentioned in the theme. Any new points that have not been mentioned earlier must not be included here to justify the conclusion. It must end by leaving the recipient in no doubt of the writer's orders, wishes, opinions, problems or recommendations. While these headings are seldom used in letter writing the reader should never be in doubt when he is passing from one part of the text to the next.

3. **Use of First or Third Person**. Most service correspondence is written in the third person. Exceptions to this convention are: -

a. Formal letters.

b. Demi-Official letters.

c. Letters from a superior in which he expresses his personal views, or conveys praise or blame and which he signs personally.

4. **Abbreviation**. In deciding whether to abbreviate the writer must ask himself "will the reader understand this abbreviation"? The following rules constitute general Naval practices: -

a. Formal letters do not contain abbreviations.

b. Demi-Official letters to members of the public do not contain abbreviations. A useful method is to spell out in full the first time it appears and show the abbreviated form in brackets immediately after.

5. **Level, Style and Tone**.

a. **Level**. Difficulty may often be experienced in selecting the level at which letters should be pitched and in applying the right tone to the occasion. The writer must consider the reader of his letter and must state facts and ideas at that level of intellectual appropriateness.

b. **Style and Tone**. A simple and direct style is most likely to be convincing. The tone may be influenced by the subject level and purpose of the letter. Letters for example can be demanding, corrective or persuasive, each requiring its own different tone.

## Types of Correspondence

6. There are eight types of service correspondence. The first six are known as service letters. Some useful hints on letter writing are enumerated at succeeding paragraphs.

a. Command letters.

b. Directed letters.

c. Routine letters.

d. Business letters.

e. Formal letters.

f. Demi-Official letters.

g. Minutes.

h. Memoranda.

7. **Command Letters**. Command letters are formal letters issued by the Ministry of Defence in the name of the Commander in Chief, Minister of Defence or the Security Council and are reserved for statements of major policy, directives and letters of special character. The Secretary Defence or Assistant Secretaries normally signs them according to the nature and importance of the subject. Their format is not subject to normal rules and no example can therefore be given. However, an example is shown at **Annex A**.

8. **Directed Letters**. Directed letters are used by Naval Staff to indicate to ships and establishments clear instructions given by the Commander of the Navy. The Secretary or a designated Staff Officer normally signs them. An example of directed letters is shown at **Annex B and C**.

9. **Routine Letters**. Routine letters are the normal form of correspondence in the Navy. A routine letter may be written by Naval Headquarters or by a Commanding Officer of a Ship or Establishment to another Commanding Officer of a Ship or Establishment. There is no salutation in routine letters. Examples of routine letters are shown at **Annex D to F**.

10. **Person**. Routine letters are normally written in the third person. When it is written in the first person it is an indication that the writer has strong personal views on the subject, and this tends to add emphasis to the letter. When the first person is used it is common practice to confine its use only to one or two paragraphs and relevant to the third person in other paragraphs. The first person cannot of course be used in letters signed 'for Commanding Officer'.

11. **Signatory**. Only the Commander of the Navy can write letters from Naval Headquarters. In the case of an Area command it will be the Area Authority or in the case of a ship or establishment it will be the Commanding Officer. This does not mean that they must personally sign all letters. But it must be written as from them. They may delegate authority to selected officers to sign on their behalf. Such correspondence is then signed on their behalf e.g. 'for Commander of the Navy' or 'for Commander Eastern Naval Area' etc. For example Supply Officers are usually delegated authority to write on stores and accounting matters. All Directors and Heads of Departments are normally authorised by Commander of the Navy to write to other ships and establishments on administrative, special or routine matters. An officer senior to the addressee should necessarily sign letters calling for explanation 'or those in the nature of an 'admonition'. The respective Directors of the Departments, Area Authorities or Commanding Officers should sign letters on matters of policy or directives. Letters requiring specific attention of higher authority on policy or other matters of an important nature should be signed by the Commanding Officer (if he is in station).

12. **Business Letters**. The format of a business letter is a slight modification of the routine letter to make it appropriate for use when writing to non-service authorities. Examples are shown at **Annex G and H**.

13. **Formal Letters**. The use of formal letters is confined to ceremonial matters and certain formal submissions; they are addressed only to seniors or equals and are signed by the originator. In the Navy, a formal letter is used for three main purposes: -

a. A personal submission or report on a personal matter such as acknowledgement of appointment or reasons in writing.

b. A personal report on an official matter such as report of proceedings or Board of Inquiry.

c. An application for trial by Court Martial (Circumstantial letter).

14. Most formal letters start with the words 'I have the honour to report'. or in the case of a circumstantial letter: 'I regret to report' It is normally appropriate for reasons in writing to start in the same way. Examples of formal letters are at **Annex J to P**.

15. **Demi-Official Letters**. Demi-Official (DO) letters are widely used in the Navy since they allow an informal and a more personal approach to service, or civilian addressees. But they are essentially service correspondence and should be restricted to one subject and filed in the normal way. The full identity of the originator is shown at the head of the letter and the salutation 'Dear' and ending 'Yours…' are inserted in manuscript by the originator. An example of a Demi-Official letter is at **Annex Q to U**.

16. **Minute Sheet**. Though minutes are not a form of service correspondence, it is widely used in the service. It is therefore appropriate that they should be dealt with for the sake of uniformity. Minute sheets can be used in two ways.

a. A loose minute sheet is used usually when a paper is circulated on its own and not in a file. This is known as loose paper circulation and is not going to be retained on completion of circulation. It can also be used to circulate a paper without calling back a file, which is already in circulation.

b. The continuation minute sheet is attached to a file.

17. **Layout of a Minute Sheet**. A number of conventions are observed in writing minutes.

a. **File Number**. Minutes are numbered serially from the start of the file number, preceded by capital letter M is written centrally above each new minute.

b. **By Whom**. Each minute is opened by the writer indicating who it is written by, in the form 'By COS' or 'By Commander...' etc using the appropriate abbreviation of his appointment or title. This phrase is always underlined.

c. **Signature and Date**. At the end of the minute the writer should sign it with his initials on the right and place the date in abbreviated form on the left.

d. **Pages**. Both back and front page of each minute sheet are used. An example of a minute sheet is at **Annex V**.

18. **Memoranda**. Memoranda are used for internal correspondence within a large organization or afloat unit. They are originated by the Senior Officer or departmental head and apply to matters confined to the Ship, Squadron or any organization. They may be used to convey information, orders and instructions. Their validity is limited in time and in due course, where necessary, is incorporated in Naval Orders and Instructions or Standing Orders to give permanency. Examples are placed at Annex **W and X**.

## AN EXAMPLE OF A COMMAND LETTER

1”

**ANNEX A TO CHAPTER 7**

**SECURITY CLASSIFICATION**

Ministry of Defence
D/ 05 Colombo 01

The Commander of the Army
The Commander of the Navy
The Commander of the Air Force
The Inspector General of Police

21st May 2005

1½” ½”

**SECURITY MEASURES FOR THE FORTHCOMING SOUTH ASIAN ASSOCIATION FOR REGIONAL CO-OPERATION SUMMIT**

1. The South Asian Association for Regional Co-operation (SAARC) summit is scheduled to be held in Colombo from 1st June 2005 to 4th June 2005. It is expected that Heads of State of all the member countries will take part. In consequent to a meeting held at the Ministry of Defence chaired by the Honourable Minister of Defence, necessity of providing a security blanket for the summit was discussed. To implement such action plan, therefore, needs meticulous planning, mobilizing resources and conducting rehearsals. It is quintessential that armed forces and the police work out a joint action plan, so that all intricacies can be overcome.

2. In this context, snap cordon and search operations, manning of road blocks and alternative traffic arrangements to the public and security network for the visiting dignitaries must be meticulously worked out.

**SECURITY CLASSIFICATION**

59

1”

**SECURITY CLASSIFICATION**

3. Hence coordinate amongst each Service and propose a suitable action plan, in order to have a full proof security mechanism in place, for this important regional summit.

sd/-
xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx
Secretary
Ministry of Defence



**SECURITY CLASSIFICATION**

**ANNEX B TO**
**CHAPTER 7**

## AN EXAMPLE OF A DIRECTED LETTER

**CONFIDENTIAL**

Naval Headquarters
NAHA 9/ 05 Colombo 01

The Commander Eastern Naval Area 09 Aug 05

**REQUIREMENT OF ADDITIONAL MANPOWER**

Reference: Your letter No CENA 34/05 dated 17 Jul 05.

1. The requirement of additional manpower projected vide quoted reference has been examined. Regrettably, however, due to the acute shortages being faced in other areas, and the requirement to man several newly acquired ships, providing additional manpower to Eastern Naval Area is, for the moment, not feasible.

2. However, in view of the contentions validating the necessity, the projections will be re-considered, after completion of training of recently joined recruit batches.

sd/
MDS ABEYWICKRAMA
Captain(C)
Director Naval Personnel
for Commander of the Navy

**CONFIDENTIAL**

**ANNEX C TO**
**CHAPTER 7**

## AN EXAMPLE OF A DIRECTED LETTER

**RESTRICTED**

Naval Headquarters
NAHA 67/ 05 Colombo 01

The Commandant
Naval & Maritime Academy 09 Sep 05

**PROPOSALS FOR UNIVERSITY ENTRY SCHEME OFFICER CADETS**

Reference: Your letter No 64/ 05 dated 20 Aug 05.

1. The proposals made in paragraph 1 of quoted reference pertaining to awarding of class passes and corresponding seniority for officer cadets once they become commissioned is approved in principle by the Commander of the Navy. These suggestions will be incorporated into the relevant governing SLNO and promulgated thereafter.

2. However with regard to contents in paragraph 2 of quoted reference, the Commander of the Navy is of the opinion that extending the academic year by an additional year will adversely affect manning of ships and craft and hence the proposal is not approved.

sd/-
JGH HAPUINNE
Captain (S)
Secretary
for Commander of the Navy

**RESTRICTED**

**ANNEX D TO**
**CHAPTER 7**

## AN EXAMPLE OF A ROUTINE LETTER FROM A COMMANDING OFFICER

| | |
|---|---|
| | SLNS Jayasagara |
| J5 | At Trincomalee |
| The Commanding Officer | |
| SLNS Ruhuna | 10 Feb 04 |

**ACCOMMODATION FOR MENIK GANGA EXPEDITION**

References: A. The Commanding Officer SLNS Ruhuna letter No RUH / 04 dated 15 Jan 04.
B. The Commander of the Navy letter NAHA No 5/ A dated 30 Jan 04.

1. It would be appreciated if accommodation for officers and sailors of the 'Menik Ganga Expedition' could be arranged at SLNS Ruhuna from 06 Apr 04 to 09 Apr 04. It is expected that two officers, six Midshipmen, two Petty Officers and six junior sailors will require accommodation.

2. The expedition will use SLNS Ruhuna as the forward assembly area and will test out their equipment, including the new RFDs in Tangalle harbour.

3. All necessary transport and equipment will accompany the team. Personnel in attached list from FAC squadron at Trincomalee will take passage onboard SLNS Hansaya to join expedition at SLNS Ruhuna.

4. Full details of the expedition and its objectives are contained in Reference A.

T P DE SILVA
Commander (C)
Commanding Officer

**Enclosure**: List of personnel.

**Copy to**:
The Commanding Officer Fast Attack Flotilla 4

**Information**:
The Commander of the Navy
The Commander Southern Naval Area
The Commanding Officer SLNS Hansaya

**ANNEX E TO**
**CHAPTER 7**

## EXAMPLE OF A ROUTINE LETTER FROM COMMANDER OF THE NAVY SIGNED BY A STAFF OFFICER

| | |
|---|---|
| | Naval Headquarters |
| NAHA 706 | Colombo 01 |
| The Commanding Officer | |
| SLNS Elara | 22 Nov 05 |

**NAVY WEEK CELEBRATIONS – 2005**

References: A. The Commander of the Navy letter No NAHA 706 dated 16 Sep 05.
B. Commanding Officer SLNS Elara Letter No E 32 dated 13 Nov 05.

1. The proposals contained in Reference B are agreed to.

2. The date for the 'MANGALA BHOJANA' should be finalised in consultation with Flag Lieutenant during the first week of Dec 05.

D S JAYASINGHE
Rear Admiral
Chief of Staff
for Commander of the Navy

**ANNEX F TO**
**CHAPTER 7**

## EXAMPLE OF A ROUTINE LETTER WITH MULTIPLE ADDRESSEES AND ONE PARAGRAPH

| | |
|---|---|
| | SLNS Sayura |
| SD 16 | At Colombo |
| The Commanding Officer SLNS Shakthi | |
| The Commanding Officer SLNS Prathapa | |
| The Commanding Officer SLNS Udara | |
| The Commanding Officer SLNS Ranajaya | 18 Sep 05 |

**MIDSHIPMEN EXAMINATION BOARD NOVEMBER 2005**

Reference: SLNO 0898.

The Board of Examiners nominated for Midshipmen Examination will be required for this purpose in Colombo during week commencing 20 Oct 05. Detailed arrangements will be promulgated shortly.

S RANASINGHE
Lieutenant Commander
for Commanding Officer (AOD)

**Information**: The Commander of the Navy
The Commander Eastern Naval Area

**Notes**

1. Ships in order of seniority.

2. Over five addressees switch to 'See Distribution'.

3. Shows subscription when Commanding Officer is away from station.

4. Single paragraph is not numbered.

**ANNEX G TO**
**CHAPTER 7**

## AN EXAMPLE OF A BUSINESS LETTER

| | |
|---|---|
| | Naval and Maritime Academy |
| | Naval Base |
| VL/ 3 | Trincomalee |
| | |
| Professor RM Hitinayaka | |
| Centre for Strategic Studies | |
| University of Colombo | |
| Colombo - 7 | 31st March 2005 |

Sir,

**LECTURE ON REVOLUTION IN MILITARY AFFAIRS**
**TO OFFICER UNDER TRAINEES**

1. The Subject of Revolution in Military Affairs (RMA) is generating lot of interest now a days in the minds of the military strategists and tacticians. With the technological innovations such as Net Centric Warfare and changes in Concept of Operations, the modern day Commanders can checkmate an unknown enemy from far away, thus bringing the battle zone to the own backyard. It is imperative that officers of the Armed Forces of Sri Lanka must be conversant with this type of modern day military lexicon, which is becoming a trendsetter.

2. The Naval and Maritime Academy is the bedrock for nurturing and training of officer under trainees. Educating them on a very interesting subject like Revolution in Military Affairs will be immensely beneficial for them to enhance their knowledge and broaden the horizon. It is felt that with your wealth of experience as an erudite academician and credentials, sharing your knowledge with the future officer corps of the Navy, would be invaluable.

3. Accordingly, it would be most grateful if you could kindly deliver this lecture for our officer under trainees. The talk, inclusive of a traditional half an hour of audience-interaction (by way of a question-answer session), has been tentatively scheduled from 0930 hours to 1130 hours on 20th April 2005.

4. Looking forward to a fruitful interaction, a copy of the detailed 'Terms of Reference' is enclosed herewith for your perusal and eagerly await confirmation from you.

Yours faithfully,

CD BAMUNUARACHCHI
Commodore, SLN
Commandant

**Enclosure**: Terms of Reference

2

**ANNEX H TO**
**CHAPTER 7**

## AN EXAMPLE OF A BUSINESS LETTER

**RESTRICTED**

Naval Headquarters
DNT/ 244 Colombo 01
Tele 011-2421151 Extn 2411

The Manager
Computer Information (Private) Ltd
143, Baseline Road
Colombo 01 27th February 2005

Dear Sir,

**TRAINING PROGRAMME FOR APPRENTICES**

1. With reference to your Letter number 2875/ CBT dated 05th February 2005, offering to train dockyard artificers in the operation of your computerized test equipment, we are pleased to accept your offer on the terms and conditions agreed-to by your representatives, in January this year.

2. As discussed earlier, the installation of the test equipment is to be completed in Building No 43 of the Naval Dockyard, by 30th April 2005, so that we can then proceed with the formalities of handing and taking over, user-trials, etc.

**RESTRICTED**

RESTRICTED

3. Please be advised that our first batch of artificers would be ready to commence training with effect from 15th April 2005.

Thanking you,

Yours faithfully,

JM ANDARAWAWA
Commodore
Director Naval Training
for Commander of the Navy

2

RESTRICTED

**ANNEX J TO**
**CHAPTER 7**

## EXAMPLE OF FORMAL LETTERS

| | |
|---|---|
| | SLNS Gemunu |
| | Naval Base |
| LP/ 01 | Welisara |
| | Tel… |
| The Commander Eastern Naval Area | 07th March 2005 |

Sir,

**ACKNOWLEDGEMENT OF APPOINTMENT**

1. I have the honour to acknowledge my appointment as Command Operations Officer (East) under your command with effect from 10th March 2005, as promulgated vide Naval Headquarters signal DTG 271618 Feb 05. I will report to assume duties on 10th March 2005.

2. It is requested that a suitable accommodation be provided to me at wardroom and my present address is as follows: -

SLNS Gemunu
Naval Base
Welisara

Yours faithfully,

sd/-
xxxxxxxxxxxx, RSP
Commander (N)

**Copy to**:
Secretary Eastern Naval Area Wardroom
Commanding Officer SLN Dockyard

**ANNEX K TO**
**CHAPTER 7**

**SECRET**

OP IMMEDIATE
Fast Attack Squadron
Naval Base
FAF/ OP/ 05 Trincomalee
Tel…

The Flag Officer Commanding Naval Fleet 21st March 2005

Sir,

**FORWARDING OF REPORT OF PROCEEDINGS**
**OPERATION 'CHASER'**

1. I have the honour to report the successful completion of Operation 'CHASER', conducted on the eastern seaboard between 01st March 2005 and 08th March 2005.

2. While the details of the operation and the various returns required have been attached herewith, suffice to say at this juncture, that all personnel conducted themselves in an exemplary manner and there were numerous instances of bravery and beyond the call of duty, details of which I shall be forwarding separately. I am proud to further report that the



SECRET

**SECRET**

enemy was annihilated and much of his ships that escaped sinking, were rendered 'hors de combat' and are unlikely to venture into sea for the period of hostilities.

Yours faithfully,

sd/-
RMB WELAGEDARA, RWP
Commander (ND)
Commanding Officer

**Annexes**: A. Diary of Events
B. Analysis of Surface Action
C. Op 'CHASER' – Track Charts

2 of 2

**SECRET**

**ANNEX L TO**
**CHAPTER 7**

**PERSONAL AND CONFIDENTIAL**

SLNS Parakrama
W/ 05 Colombo 01
Tel.…

The Commanding Officer
SLNS Parakrama 03rd April 2005

Sir,

**EXPLANATION FOR DERELICTION OF DUTY**

Reference: The Commanding Officer SLNS Parakrama Letter No PK/35 dated 29th March 2005.

1. I regret to report my negligence in the discharge of my duties as the Officer of the Day of SLNS Parakrama on 28th February 2005, in which I was absent from my place of duty for a considerable period of time. As a result when the Commander Western Naval Area visited SLNS Parakrama to address a gathering of officers, I was not unable to accord proper marks of respect, upon the latter's arrival. The circumstances leading to lapse were as follows: -

a. I informed the Assistant Duty Officer to contact me in an emergency as I would be away from the base in the morning hours. Regrettably he did not communicate with me.

**PERSONAL AND CONFIDENTIAL**

**PERSONAL AND CONFIDENTIAL**

b. I was not notified about the Commander Western Naval Area' visit, as it was a non working day, presuming that such a meeting will not be held.

c. In actuality, I went to attend for an urgent personal chore, instructing Assistant Duty Officer to oversee duties until my return to base.

2. I comprehend the inadequacy of the reasons offered above and wish to submit that I deeply regret my negligence and shall endeavour to make amends in the future.

Yours faithfully,

PK MALWANA
Lieutenant Commander (E)

2

**PERSONAL AND CONFIDENTIAL**

**ANNEX M TO**
**CHAPTER 7**

**CONFIDENTIAL**

PRIORITY
SLNS Sayura
Port of Colombo
137/ 2 Colombo 01

The Flag Officer Commanding Naval Fleet 01st October 2005

Sir,

**FORWARDING BOI REPORT OF THE GROUNDING OF SLNS KORAWAKKA**

1. I have the honour to forward in quadruplicate, the minutes of the proceedings, along with the findings and recommendations of the Board of Inquiry assembled onboard Sri Lanka Naval Ship Sayura, in compliance with FOCNF letter No 144/ 6 dated 28th September 2005 to investigate into the circumstances leading to the grounding of Sri Lanka Naval Ship Korawakka, on the Banks of Misery, around 2000 hrs on 04th September 2005.

**CONFIDENTIAL**

**CONFIDENTIAL**

2. The shorthand notes of the stenographer detailed to record the minutes and a copy of the Convening Order, are also enclosed herewith.

Yours faithfully,

AOP JAYASEKARA
Captain (G)
Commanding Officer

**Enclosures**: 1. Minutes of the proceedings.
2. Shorthand Notes.
3. Copy of FOCNF letter No144/6 dated 28th September 1998 Convening Order).

2

**CONFIDENTIAL**

**ANNEX N TO**
**CHAPTER 7**

**PERSONAL AND CONFIDENTIAL**

SLNS Balawatha
BAL 035/ 1 At Trincomalee

Lieutenant H Ruwansiri 05th June 2005

**WARNING TO SHOW IMPROVEMENT**
**LIEUTENANT H RUWANSIRI NRX 1233**

1. Whereas I have, on several occasions over the past two months, afforded you both counsel and caution as to the slackness displayed by you in the discharge of your duties as Navigation and Direction Officer of SLNS Balawatha, under my Command, I observe with dismay, that you have made little or no effort to show any discernible improvement.

2. You have, despite all help afforded to you by way of guidance from the Executive Officer as well as by way of support from a subordinate officer specifically detailed to assist you, remained careless and inattentive in demeanour and casual in your approach. In adopting this cavalier attitude you have, on more than one occasion, placed the ship and the well-being of her Company, in danger.

3. In direct, flagrant and periodic contravention of Sections 2-12 to 2-22 of my Standing Orders, you have failed to: -

a. Regularly prepare and put-up for my approval, the Leaving Harbour Plan and the Passage Plan of the ship.

b. Maintain the ship's Log and the Ship's Navigation Data Book.

PERSONAL AND CONFIDENTIAL

**PERSONAL AND CONFIDENTIAL**

c. Carry out training to Subordinate Officer of the Executive Branch in the practice of astro-navigation.

d. Acquaint yourself sufficiently with the procedures established to cater for machinery breakdowns and bridge emergencies.

4. Being mindful of your seniority and your earlier fine academic performance, I do hereby caution you one last time, to show discernible and significant improvement, failing which I shall proceed to deal with you formally, under the powers vested in me as Commanding Officer of Sri Lanka Naval Ship Balawatha.

P WEERASINGE
Commander (N)
Commanding Officer



**PERSONAL AND CONFIDENTIAL**

**ANNEX P TO**
**CHAPTER 7**

## LAYOUT OF A FORMAL LETTER – PERSONAL SUBMISSION

| | |
|---|---|
| Attention: Director Naval Training | |
| | |
| | SLNS Uththara |
| J/ 01/ 05 | Kankesanturai |
| | Tel… Ext… |
| | |
| The Commander of the Navy | |
| | |
| Through: The Commanding Officer SLNS Uththara | |
| The Commander Northern Naval Area | 26th August 2005 |
| | |
| | |
| Sir, | |
| | |
| | |
| **PROVIDING AN OPPORTUNITY TO OBTAIN THE OCEAN NAVIGATION CERTIFICATE** | |
| | |
| | |
| 1. I have the honour to submit following aspects for your kind perusal and favourable consideration in order to obtain the Ocean Navigation Certificate. | |
| | |
| 2. It is kindly intimated that presently I am serving as Staff Officer Operations (North) under Commander Northern Naval Area. I was promoted to the rank of Temporary Lieutenant Commander on 01st May 2003 and not yet confirmed in my present rank. In my view delay in confirmation is due to non-possession of the Ocean Navigation Certificate. It may be noted that many officers junior to me have already obtained the Ocean Navigation Certificate and been confirmed in the rank. With the acquisition of number of new ships in the Sri Lanka Navy it is opined that the existing backlog can be cleared. The non-confirmation in my present rank has created lot of mental agony despite completing all other pre-requisites. | |
| | |
| | |
| | |
| | |
| | |
| | |

3. Therefore, considering aforesaid facts, it is kindly requested that I be given an opportunity to obtain the Ocean Navigation Certificate at the earliest opportunity.

Yours faithfully,

MAB JEERASINGHE
T/ Lieutenant Commander (G)

2

**ANNEX Q TO**
**CHAPTER 7**

## EXAMPLES OF DEMI OFFICIAL LETTERS

Lieutenant Commander RS Siriwardena

SLNS Tissa
Naval Base
RS/ 05 Trincomalee
Tel…

01 Nov 05

Dear Sir,

1. Request accept my heartiest congratulations on your promotion to the rank of Commodore. I am profoundly delighted on your well deserved promotion. My wife Darshini joins me in wishing you and your family continued success in all your future endeavours.

2. May the noble triple gem bless you and further give you good health, courage and strength to accomplish all your future expectations as well.

Yours faithfully,
sd/-

Commodore GK Hapugoda
Naval Headquarters
Colombo 1

**ANNEX R TO**
**CHAPTER 7**

Captain (N) DG Gamage

Naval Headquarters
DG/ 02 Colombo 01
Tel…

03 Nov 05

Dear Mahesh,

1. Please accept my heartfelt congratulations on your worthy promotion to the rank of Commander. I am elated for your well deserved promotion and on your joining the Sri Lanka Navy's merry band of 'Brass hats'. My wife Asha joins me in wishing you and your family continued success in all future endeavours.

2. May the Almighty bless you and give courage and wisdom to accomplish all your future expectations as well.

Yours aye,
sd/-

Commander (C) CM Wimalaratna
SLNS Elara
Karainagar

**ANNEX S TO**
**CHAPTER 7**

Commodore GK Hapugoda

Naval Headquarters
GKS 01 Colombo 01
Tel…

10 Nov 05

Dear Rohitha,

1. I am very much thankful for the felicitation message sent by you on the occasion of my promotion. In fact I fondly remember my association with you onboard SLNS Jayasagara.

2. I take this opportunity to wish you and your family all the best and success in future endeavours.

.

Yours aye,
sd/-

Lieutenant Commander RS Siriwardena
SLNS Tissa
Naval Base
Trincomalee

.

**ANNEX T TO**
**CHAPTER 7**

Commander (C) CK Kapilaratna

SLNS Dakshina
CK/ 09 Galle
Tel…

15 Oct 05

Sir,

Request accept my deepest sympathies on bereavement of your father. I was very sad on hearing this sorrowful news. My thoughts and prayers are with you in this grief stricken hour. I was not able to avail my presence at the funeral due to service commitments and may your father attain supreme bliss of Nibbana.

Yours faithfully,

sd/-

Captain (N) MHM Warusavithana
Naval Headquarters
Colombo 1

**ANNEX U TO**
**CHAPTER 7**

Lieutenant Commander NM Panditharatna

SLNS Vijaya
Naval Base
NM/ 07 Kalpitiya
Tel…

15 Oct 05

Dear Dharmasiri,

Please accept my deepest sympathies on the demise of your father. It was a very sad moment for my family. Our thoughts and prayers are with you in this hour of grief. I was not able to avail my presence at the funeral due to service commitments and may your father's soul rest in peace.

Yours aye,

sd/-

Lieutenant DCN Ariyasiri
Naval Headquarters
Colombo 1

**Note** When senior officer is writing a DO letter to a junior officer, then it may be appropriate to use 'Yours aye' instead of 'Yours faithfully' or 'Yours sincerely'.

**ANNEX V TO CHAPTER 7**

## EXAMPLE OF A MINUTE SHEET

## MINUTE SHEET

| REFER TO: | **EXTENSION TO WARDROOM** |
|---|---|
| DNCE<br>DG (LOG)<br>COS | M1<br>BY SEC<br>1. Ref F 36. CO Elara has requested for an extension to W/R. Proposal is to convert present dining room into a TV room, modify part of present galley into a dining room and build a new compact galley.<br>2. Proposed plan at F 35.<br>3. No provision in current year's capital budget.<br>sd/-<br>01 Oct 05 NN PERERA<br>Commodore<br>M2<br>BY DNCE<br>1. Ref M1. The plan is acceptable. DDCE will study this and compile a BOQ and estimate.<br>2. Approval of C of N is required.<br>sd/-<br>10 Oct 05 SRG DIAS<br>Commodore<br>M3<br>BY DG (LOG)<br>1. Ref M2. It is opined that CO Elara has delayed in sending the proposal. There is no allocation for this in Capital Expenditure proposals already submitted to Ministry for 2006.<br>2. Supplementary work of this nature cannot be undertaken at this juncture. The |

proposal may be considered for 2007 and CO, Elara may be asked to forward a fresh proposal in early 2006.

sd/-
21 Oct 05 KH SILVA
Rear Admiral

M4

BY COS

1. Ref. M3. Reply CO Elara that proposal is agreed to; but can only be considered for inclusion in Capital Expenditure proposals for 2007.

2. In the meantime CCEO to visit Elara to examine the feasibility of undertaking the job.

sd/-
29 Oct 05 MM HAPUTANTRI
Rear Admiral

M5

BY SEC

1. Ref. M4. Noted for action.

sd/-
30 Oct 05 NN PERERA
Commodore

Notes

1. There is no necessity to end a minute with word ‘please’.

2. Staff Officers should cross out their short titles under 'Refer to' when they have taken action. If they have not made a minute (remark) they should initial and insert date alongside the crossed out title. In case a staff officer wants to refer the minute to some other staff officer/ directorate who has not been referred to but whose inputs are felt necessary, then he can mark the file to that particular staff officer/ directorate.

**ANNEX W TO**
**CHAPTER 7**

## EXAMPLES OF MEMORANDUM

Naval Headquarters
NAHA 5 Colombo 01

See Distribution 23 Jan 05

**MEMORANDUM**

**USE OF HOLIDAY WARRANTS DURING TRAINING PERIOD ABROAD**

1. Sri Lanka Navy personnel undergoing training abroad may obtain one return, Holiday Railway Warrant for a distance not, exceeding 500 Km each way or three sets of return warrants from the Training Establishment to which they are attached. This facility is provided in lieu of the annual three (03) sets of warrants to which they are entitled in Sri Lanka.

2. This concession may be availed of only if the trainees spend one full year under training in the particular country.

3. The Holiday Railway Warrants issued in India are only for travel within India subject to conditions at paragraph 1 above.

4. It will be the responsibility of the trainees who make use of this facility to indicate to Naval Headquarters in their monthly progress reports the particulars of Holiday Warrants drawn.

5. Necessary amendments to SLNO 0850 will be made in due course.

L S PERERA, RSP, USP
Commodore (S)
Secretary
for Commander of the Navy

**Distribution**: Full

**ANNEX X TO CHAPTER 7**

| | |
|---|---|
| | Command Headquarters |
| | Naval Base |
| CE/05 | Trincomalee |
| See Distribution | 05 Dec 05 |

**COMMANDER EASTERN NAVAL AREA TEMPORARY MEMORANDUM-SERVICING OF NAVY VEHICLES**

1. It is of paramount importance that all Navy vehicles in the Eastern Naval Area are serviced periodically in order to have fully functional fleet of vehicles.

2. A schedule in respect of servicing of vehicles from 01Jan 06 to 31 Dec 06 has been prepared and attached herewith as an **annexure**. This schedule will invariably help the servicing of all vehicles in Eastern Naval Area in a well-organized manner.

3. The Commanding Officers/ Officers in Command/ Heads of Department are hereby directed to ensure that the vehicles attached to respective ships/establishments are released to facilitate servicing of vehicles by NMTO as per the schedule indicated.

4. It is also pertinent to mention that there will be no allocation of stand-in vehicles during the servicing period.

sd/-
xxxxxxxxxx, RWP, RSP, psc
Commander Eastern Naval Area

**Annexure**: Vehicle Service Schedule

**Distribution**: Commandant Naval & Maritime Academy
Commanding Officer SLNS Tissa
Commanding Officer SLN Dockyard
Commanding Officer SBS
CCON

# CHAPTER 8

# TOUR NOTES

1. A Tour Note is an important report to be rendered by a Commander/ Staff Officer on conclusion of an official visit to a Naval area/ establishment. It should be borne in mind that 'Tour Notes' should be recorded, for all concerned to be aware of what transpired during a particular visit, so as to enable the staff to take necessary follow up action. Tour Notes are, therefore, not only the prerogative of NAs/ SOs to Commander of the Navy/ PSOs/ and other Flag Officers, but an obligatory function of any Staff Officer proceeding on tour.

## Title

2. The following is an example of a title as might be encountered within the Naval environment: -

**TOUR NOTES ON THE VISIT OF THE COMMANDER OF THE NAVY TO EASTERN NAVAL AREA 05-07 NOV O5**

## Signing of the Tour Notes and Use of First/ Third Person

3. In practice, staff officers will find that it is only when the officer undertaking the tour is relatively junior in rank or position, that 'tour notes' are written in the first person and signed by the officer who had undertaken the tour.

4. In other cases, when the officer undertaking the tour is a Flag Officer/ Senior Officer, the tour notes would be drafted by the accompanying staff officer. These draft notes would be processed on file and the PSO's approval obtained. Thereafter, the tour notes would be 'faired out' by the concerned staff officer and signed by the latter – with the notation that the notes have the approval of the Flag/ Senior Officer concerned.

## Indication of Action to be Taken

5. The indication should be more specific and robust. It should always be immediately clear as to 'who' is to take 'what' specific action. While the style adopted in the tour notes need not be pedantic or stilted, it ought to be remembered that this document gets circulated at a fairly senior level and is taken seriously by all concerned. Hence, a conscious effort must be made to avoid a style, which is 'chatty' or colloquial. The tour notes are written in past tense. Decisions are expressed in imperative form. An example of a 'Tour Note' is shown in **Annex A.**

**ANNEX A**
**CHAPTER 8**

## AN EXAMPLE OF TOUR NOTE

**RESTRICTED**

Naval Headquarters
V/ 03/ 05 Colombo 01
Tele…

See Distribution 15 Dec 05

**TOUR NOTES ON THE VISIT OF THE COMMANDER OF THE NAVY TO NORTHERN NAVAL AREA 07-09 DEC 05**

1. The Commander of the Navy accompanied by following Director Generals and Directors made a routine visit to Northern Naval Area to ascertain the activities taking place in Northern Naval Area and to brief Naval personnel in the area about the new developments in the Navy: -

a. DG (O)
b. DG (E)
c. DG (LOG)
d. DNP
e. DNW
f. DNT
g. DNL
h. DNMS
j. DNCE

2. The Commander of the Navy and his entourage visited key Naval establishments in the area and held intense discussions with the Commander Northern Naval Area and his staff. The directives given by C of N on important aspects that were discussed are enumerated in the succeeding paragraphs.

RESTRICTED

## ITEM 1- ACCOMMODATION SHORTAGE

3. CNNA gave a brief description pertaining to lack of proper accommodation facilities to personnel in the area. The C of N instructed DNCE to carryout an in-depth study on this issue and ways of utilizing direct labour to expedite the construction work.

4. **Decision.** DNCE to submit relevant proposals to C of N and brief by 30 Jan 06.

## ITEM 2 – TRANSFER OF LEAVE/ AFTER LEAVE PERSONNEL

4. It was brought to the notice of C of N that sometimes Naval personnel get stranded at either end due to constraints of transport.

5. **Decision.** DG (O) to liase with SLAF authorities to find ways of solving the problem and also to study the possibility of chartering a merchant vessel.

## ITEM 3 – WARD MASTERS FOR NAVAL BASES

6. Most of the COs in the area opined the necessity of attaching ward masters to each base. DNMS indicated that the present existing vacuum cannot be filled.

7. **Decision**. DNMS to check the possibility of filling the requirement through nursing qualified senior sailors.

RESTRICTED

## ITEM 4- ADDITIONAL MANPOWER FOR SECURITY DUTIES

8. It was revealed during the meeting that approximately 300 additional sailors are required to supplement the prevailing manpower shortage in the area. The C of N expressed that as a temporary measure to find feasibility of deploying personnel attached to the Training Battalion, until the new batch of recruits complete their training.

9. **Decision**. DNP to check the feasibility of early deployment.

## ITEM 5 - WATER BOWSERS FOR SLNS KANCHADEVA AND SLNS AGBO

10. CNNA mentioned that urgent requirement exists to have one bowser each to SLNS Kanchadeva and SLNS Agbo as existing ones are subjected to constant repairs and not cost effective to maintain the same.

11. **Decision**. CNNA to check whether these vehicles have been projected under capital expenditure proposals and DG (LOG) to expedite the process.

## ITEM 6 - ……

12. …….

13. **Decision.** .....

RESTRICTED

**ITEM 7 - ……..**

14. …….

15. **Decision**. …….

16. These tour notes have the approval of the Commander of the Navy.

sd/-
xxxxxxxxx, USP, psc
Commander (N)
Naval Assistant

**Distribution**:

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……..
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……..